4.3 The 3-Touch Follow-Up System - Persistence Without the Stench

Elite private strategy - not for redistribution

WAR-ROOM NOTES - 4.3 The 3-Touch Follow-Up System

THE CUMULATIVE-RESPONSE CURVE (WHY 3 TOUCHES, NOT 1, NOT 5)

Cold-outreach response curves in radio behave predictably: touch 1 gets its share; touch 2 recovers the "busy but interested" cohort; touch 3 recovers the "I need a deadline" cohort. Beyond touch 3, the marginal conversion collapses to near-zero while the well-burn risk rises sharply - a fourth touch converts the negative direction: PDs remember being chased, and the memory persists for years. Three touches is not a suggestion; it's the mathematically optimal persistence policy for relationship-preserving outreach.

THE TOUCH ROTATION RULE: NEVER REPEAT AN ASSET

Each touch must present new value. If touch 2 repeats touch 1's audio link, you've sent a reminder - which reads as a no-value message and costs you credibility. Rotate: touch 1 = the pitch + audio; touch 2 = new proof (crowd video, spin receipt, milestone); touch 3 = the graceful close with a new but tiny asset (a 15-sec vertical clip or a follow-up 30-sec cutdown). Repeating the same file is the amateur tell.

THE DAY-4 / DAY-8 TIMING IS A MECHANISM, NOT A FEELING

Day 4 lands after the PD's first decision window (busy Monday, pitched Tuesday, processed Wednesday, freed Thursday). Day 8 crosses the weekly-retention cliff (most stray pitches are forgotten within a week). Day 14 (after touch 3) is where the "no-answer" station becomes a clean MONITOR with a 90-day recheck - not a graveyard of hope. The dates are chosen to compress the decision cycle, not to be polite.

THE "JUST FOLLOWING UP" BAN

Two words that signal amateur: "just following up." It implies you have nothing new, which is true. Every follow-up in this system is a proof update, a milestone update, or a grace close - never a reminder. If you have nothing new, don't send. The third touch is the only exception, and it's engineered to close, not to nag.

REPLY SPEED IS A RELATIONSHIP CURRENCY

Any touch or reply is a loan of trust; the PD decides whether you're worth a second loan based on how you handled the first. Responding to a PD's question in under 12 hours signals professional-grade operating tempo - the same tempo that makes them forward your record to a co-worker. Slow replies read as a hobby. Speed is the cheapest proof of professionalism you own.